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*The Left Hand of
Darkness*

IMPRESSIONS · READ SEPTEMBER 2026

Truth is a matter of the imagination.
The soundest fact may fail or prevail in
the style of its telling: like that singular
organic jewel of our seas, which grows
brighter as one woman wears it and, worn
by another, dulls and goes to dust. Facts
are no more solid, coherent, round and
real than pearls are. But both are sensitive.

— Gently Ai

6 SEPTEMBER 2026

On the fickle nature of "Truth".

King in his own eyes is Kharide

— -Prime Minister Estraven

6 SEPTEMBER 2026

To a king, or rather a madman, his country is not its people,
its culture, or its struggles. It is nothing but himself: his
pride and his power. The nation is the king's ego: every
wound to it is a wound to him, every praise of it is praise
of him. Every judgment of the nation is a judgment of the
king.

When I say patriotism. I mean fear.
The fear of the other. And its expressions are political, not poetical: hate, rivalry, aggression. It grows in us that fear. It grows in us year by year.

— Prime minister Estraven

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